



PLUMBER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Plumbers install and repair heating systems, boilers, water pipes, drainage systems, air-conditioning units, and domestic equipment such as washing machines. They work in homes, offices, or at industrial locations, and may be self-employed or an employee of a larger firm or business. The work involves using a wide range of equipment, from power tools to welding gear, often in wet and cramped conditions.



SALARY

Trainee plumber ★★★★★

Experienced plumber ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Numerous employment opportunities, including growth in renewable energy systems • Self-employment common • Skilled plumbers in demand in many countries worldwide

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **BUILDING-SERVICES ENGINEER** Designs and builds a wide range of systems within buildings, from lighting, heating, and power to internal features such as elevators and escalators. They work on large- and small-scale construction projects.
- ▶ **DOMESTIC APPLIANCE ENGINEER** Installs and repairs appliances, such as washing machines and refrigerators, in people's homes.
- ▶ **ENERGY ENGINEER** Develops new ways of producing energy, such as electricity, from a range of technologies, such as wind turbines.
- ▶ **KITCHEN FITTER** Installs and fits kitchen worktops, cupboards, and decorative trims. Kitchen fitters follow detailed plans to achieve the layout and look required by the customer.
- ▶ **REFRIGERATION AND VENTILATION ENGINEER** Designs, installs, and commissions air conditioning systems in people's homes, offices, schools, and other premises.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Engineering • Mathematics • Physics • Design technology • Information Technology (IT) • English



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS There are no formal entry requirements. To work with oil and gas appliances, plumbers need to be certified.



LIFESTYLE Working hours are fairly regular although plumbers may need to work evenings or weekends, or remain on call in case of emergency repairs.



LOCATION Travel between customers is required—plumbers work in a variety of locations, such as customers' offices, homes, factories, and stores.



THE REALITIES Being self-employed requires hard work and determination. Some work is carried out at late or early hours, or in wet or cold conditions.